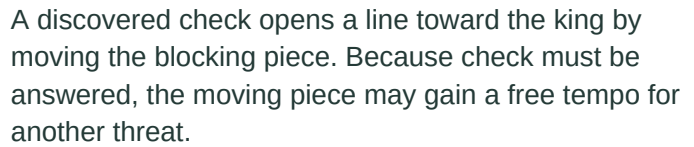


Discovered checks

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on e1. Absolute pin: pawn on e4.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

10...Qh4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **11.g3**.

12...Nxh1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the queen on h4 attacks the king on e1.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 32 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.